



In conversation with Harshil Shah of Peak



Steve Zubin Alfred of Guitar Wiz

mirrors the indie ethos. Notebook remains strictly ad-free, treating user data as sacred trust, not currency. Its design language discards sterile, text-heavy spreadsheets for vibrant, distinctively styled “cards” that make digital organisation feel like an artistic mosaic.

Pockity

If fitness apps struggle with rigidity, personal finance apps suffer from a lack of soul. They often feel punitive, dry and exhausting. Enter Nikhil Nigade, an indie veteran with 16 years of development under his belt, who openly confesses to having a historically terrible relationship with money.

“I’ve struggled with budgeting, tracking my expenses... So I wanted to

fix this,” Nigade says. His therapy was code, and the result was Pockity.

Launched in 2019, Pockity cuts through a crowded financial app market by anchoring itself to an uncompromised pillar: absolute user privacy. In an era where fintech platforms harvest and monetise user transaction data, Pockity takes a radical stance. It syncs exclusively through Apple’s iCloud, and only if the user explicitly opts in.

Despite being a solo endeavor, Nigade has scaled Pockity to support nine languages using Apple’s native localisation frameworks. The feature list includes double-entry accounting, automatic receipt edge-detection, shared ledgers for couples and even a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server

that allows advanced AI tools to interact safely with your local data.

Guitar Wiz

The intersection of code and creativity finds its ultimate expression in Guitar Wiz, an app crafted by Bijoy Thangaraj, the founder of JSplash Studios. Thangaraj, a brilliant piano player and veteran developer, partnered with seasoned touring guitarist and instructor Steve Zubin Alfred to solve a timeless dilemma: how to make practicing instrument mechanics less agonizing.

Alfred, who spent nearly two decades on stage with prominent bands like The Western Ghats, brought real-world frustration to Thangaraj’s development table. Built on the massive success of their previous tool, GtrLib Chords, Guitar Wiz maps out every conceivable chord permutation across the fretboard with pristine audio feedback and ergonomic fingering guides.

“Being in the music industry... I have a pretty good idea of what effective practice looks like,” says Alfred. “And I’m equally familiar with the frustration points.” By prioritising deep, native accessibility, Thangaraj has turned complex music theory into a tactile language that feels natural to a musician.

Letter Flow

Siblings Arima and Aman Jain are the winners of Apple’s Swift Challenge. I met them a couple of years ago when their app Lil Artist blew up. The duo has somehow found a way of coming back and impressing again. This time with Letter Flow, an interactive word-puzzle experience tailored specifically for the Liquid Glass design aesthetic of iOS 26.

Letter Flow blends the addictive loops of games like Wordle with advanced machine learning pipelines.

“Previously, we used to outsource the stories and then create artwork for them. It could take weeks,” Arima notes. “Now, we use foundation models to generate the narrative and an image creator to produce the visuals. A whole new story comes together in a fraction of the time.” 